Logic is the Beginning of Wisdom

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Abstract. ... not the end of it; so said Spock in a 1991 Star Trek movie. This paper introduces Logic Transformer, a differentiable neural network that explicitly performs classical symbolic logic inference (with rules matching, substitutions, etc). Preliminary experiments show that it achieves a very high compression ratio (ie fewer parameters) and also seems to train faster as a consequence. From the "No Free Lunch" perspective this suggests that algebraic/categorical structure of logic is suitable for compressing our world (as Wittgenstein says, logic is a mirror-image of the world). A high compression ratio forces the knowledge contained in our neural network to attain "logic coherence", which we believe is the antidote to hallucinations. The explicit logic structure also opens the "black boxes" of neural networks for inspection and interpretation. Moreover, it allows to use a classical symbolic logic inference engine (eg. OpenCog, OpenNARS) side-by-side with our neural network in a hybrid architecture, that may offer advantages we are only beginning to explore. For all these implications, we claim that this is a key innovation that solves the AGI problem.

Keywords: logic-based AI · neural-symbolic integration · LLMs (large language models)

1 Background: RL + LLM Architecture

This section outlines the basic framework required for subsequent work. We aim to combine RL (reinforcement learning) and LLMs (fig. 1). LLMs are traditionally implemented by Transformers, to be replaced by Logic Transformers.

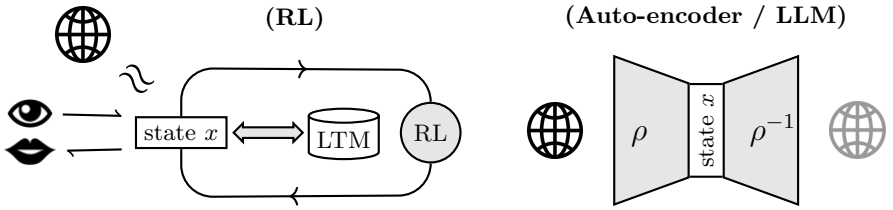


Fig. 1. Left: basic RL setup; LTM = long term memory. Right: The essence of an auto-encoder, of which LLMs are a special case, is to compress (via ρ) and reconstruct (via ρ^{-1}) world data.

Two types of architectures are possible (fig. 1), where a traditional LLM may serve as a world-model (**W**) or as a model of thinking processes (**T**). It turns out the latter is more natural and similar to mainstream approaches such as RLHF [**Li2023**]. It implies that "prompts" are regarded as Working Memory and offers the tremendous advantage that humans can read the thoughts of an AGI directly in natural language.

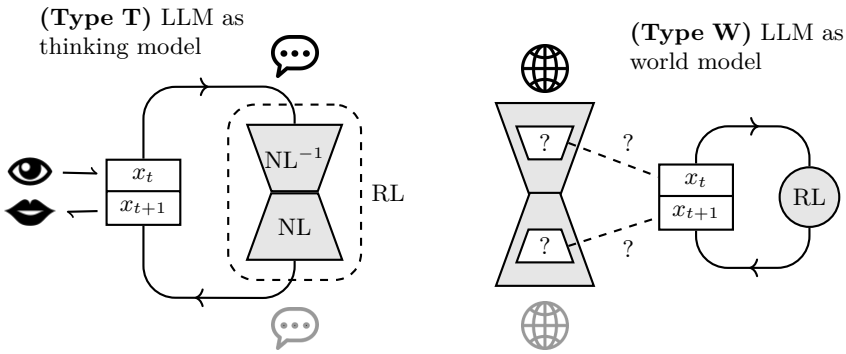
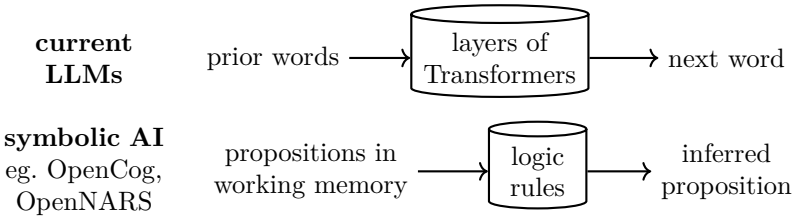


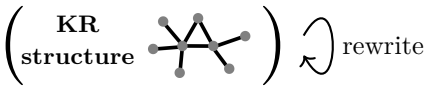
Fig. 2. Two types of RL + LLM architectures. NL^{-1} is a map that compresses natural language to a hidden representation (not shown explicitly).

As we know, LLMs predict the next word per each iteration. For a long time I have been trying to reconcile the following two views:



until I had the insight that a logic-based system could output a proposition to rewrite part of a linguistic tree or graph, similar to the LLM outputting the next word to complete a sentence.

This leads us to the following basic architecture, which is also the setup proposed by Goertzel in [**Goertzel2021**]:



(1)

One way to define a rewrite rule [**Kennaway1993**] is as a pair of morphisms $L \leftarrow K \rightarrow R$, L and R are the left and right hand sides, and K is the interface

graph. G is the input graph and H is the result of rewriting. The effect is that the part of L outside K is deleted from G and is replaced by the part of R outside K:

$$\begin{tikzcd} L \arrow[d] & K \arrow[l] \arrow[r] \arrow[d] & R \arrow[d] \\ G & D \arrow[l] \arrow[r] & H \end{tikzcd} \tag{2}$$

This occurs in a category where graphs are objects and homomorphisms define some notion of "matching". Now if we imagine a **differentiable** version of rewriting rules (see (4) below), all the rules would be represented by a set of parameters $\Theta \in \mathbb{R}^n$, and the parameterized rules *must* cover the entire family of rewrite rules as Θ vary continuously (in practice, we can limit the rules length to make that possible). This requires the use of "**discretizing**" functions such as sigmoid and softmax, and may be formulated by a fairly mechanical process. However, in doing so we have overlooked the possibility that a **deep** neural network such as Transformer may be able to aggregate all the contents of Working Memory, output some intermediate **distributive** representations, before finally outputting some discrete tokens. Such a process would imply L matches the entire input graph G in (2).

2 Logic Transformer

In classical logic-based AI, a single step of inference is a mapping $\Delta \overset{\text{KB}}{\longmapsto} \Delta + \delta$ where KB is a set of logic **rules** and Δ is a set of ground propositions or **facts**. Δ also called the state $\boldsymbol{x}$ or Working Memory. "Set" implies algebraic structure, ie, permutation invariance of elements. We recognized early on that this has a connection with the equivariance structure of Self-Attention; but it was not obvious how to extract further algebraic structures from logic and to apply such symmetries; instead, we found a way to actually implement the syntactic process of substitutions and logic-rule applications, so the resulting neural network obviously inherits logic structure implicitly. A logic rule is a formula with variables such as:

$$\forall X\ \forall Y\ \forall Z. \quad \text{father}(X, Y) \wedge \text{father}(Y, Z) \Rightarrow \text{grandfather}(X, Z) \tag{3}$$

where the variables must obey strict discipline (X matches to X, etc) as shown by dotted lines.

A key innovation is what I termed the **cylindrification factor** γ, which allows a logic constant to change continuously into a variable, as illustrated in fig. 3.

Furthering the idea, the matching (or **unification**) of variables makes use of a fixed number of variable "slots" where we "move" contents in and out of the slots by neural weights with **Softmax**, so that the transfer of contents can vary

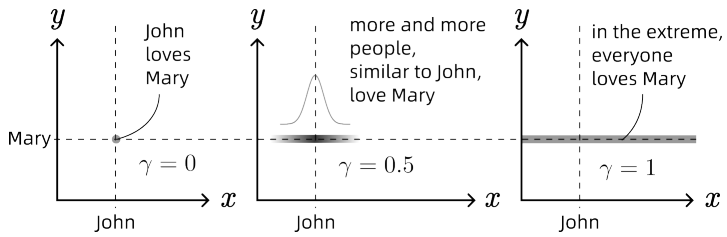
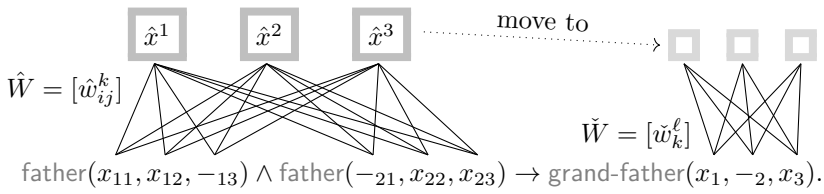


Fig. 3. Illustration of the cylindrification factor γ.

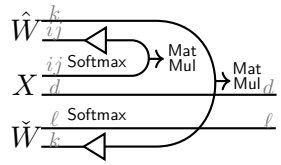
continuously:



(4)

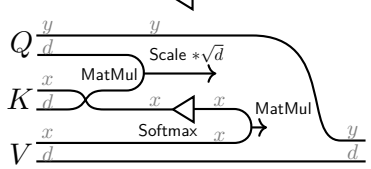
Interestingly, substitution / unification has a form very similar to **Self-Attention** except for the order of softmax and tensor product (with neural string-diagrams explained in the next section):

$$Z := \oslash \check{W} \otimes \left(\oslash \hat{W} \otimes X \right)$$



(5)

$$\alpha := \left(\oslash \frac{\langle Q, K \rangle}{\sqrt{d_k}} \right) V$$



The next step would be to match WMEs (Working Memory Elements, ie, propositions) to rule arguments. This is the point when we stopped and submitted our last paper, which was rejected. We concluded that WME matching was too complicated, and the traditional Transformer, as a distorted form of logic rules, somehow does the job equivalently, and may be even superior due to "distributive representations." Afterwards, we tried to work out the remaining parts, just for the completeness of a long research journey. It turns out what was needed is the permutations of all WMEs, which is simply the Cartesian self-product $X^{\times n}$ if we ignore "replacement" – which is okay, if one doesn't mind the same WME matching more than one part of a rule. The result is Fig. 4. Then came the amazing experimental result that it can solve TicTacToe quite efficiently. Further testing confirmed that it can solve natural-language tests with 10x fewer parameters than traditional Transformers (Fig 5L). We attribute

this efficiency to the logic structure inherent in the Logic Transformer neural network.

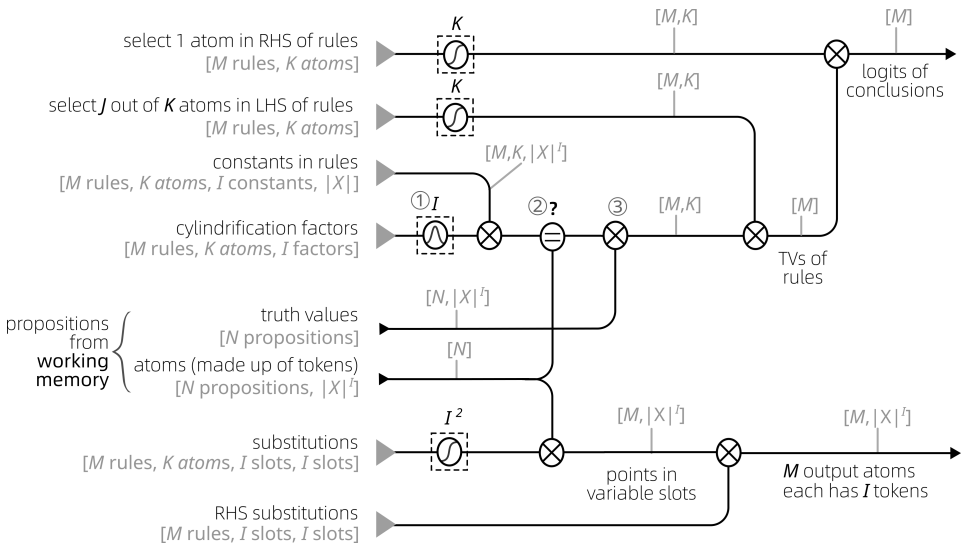


Fig. 4. String-diagram of the Logic Transformer.

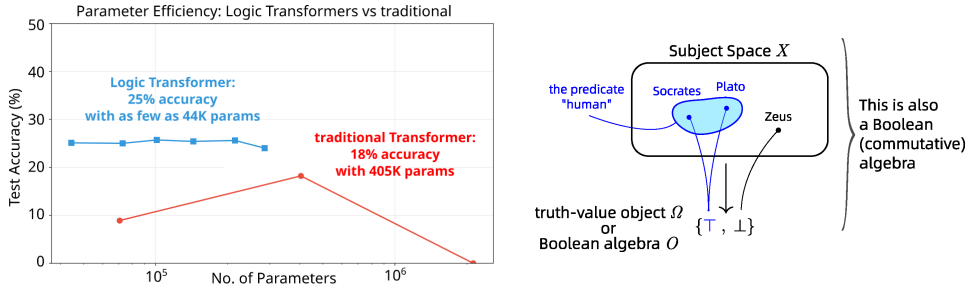


Fig. 5. (Left) Compression ratio, Logic Transformer vs traditional. (Right) Paul Halmos' lifting of propositional logic to predicate logic.

2.1 Source code and experiments

We went through 3 stages of experiments:

1	TicTacToe experiments with traditional neural nets and Transformers	`RL-TTT-experiments`
2	TicTacToe experiments with Logic Transformer	`logic-autoencoder-TTT`
3	AGI experiments with bAbI and Tiny Stories	`AGI-experiments`

All source code is under Creative Commons Zero-1.0 license and can be accessed from `http://github.com/Cybernetic1/`{insert name}. Readers can use Copilot to ask questions about our code and even contribute new material; Feel free to contact the author for assistance.

2.2 On the algebraic structure of logic and string diagrams

A natural question arises whether it is possible to simplify the string diagram (Fig. 4) to make it computationally more efficient. Some prior research has been done in this direction. The diagrams in equation (5) are **Functor String Diagrams** as described in [**Abbott2024**]. They have the advantage of keeping track of dimensions of tensors as well as preserving equivariant structure – these seem to be all we need.

The modern approach to describing the structure of logic is via categorical logic [**Jacobs1999**] [**Lambek1986**], where logic structure is encapsulated as a CCC (Cartesian closed category) or topos. This approach has the Curry-Howard correspondence [**Sorensen2006**] at its core. A parallel approach is based on relation algebra and leads to the notion of allegories.

Indeed, neural **associative memory** (such as Transformer, which are shown to be equivalent to Hopfield Networks [**Ramsauer2021**]) may be a far superior form of "logic" than traditional, formal symbolic logic. Consider the logic example:

$$\text{loves}(X, Y) \land \neg\text{loves}(Y, X) \to ☹(X) \tag{6}$$

but we immediately sense that the human brain does not work like that. It is more like: the thought of unrequited love fires a massive number of neural activations which all point to the conclusion that this is an unhappy experience. The Transformer's associative memory does exactly that.

Also recall that Self-Attention originated as a kind of **content-addressable memory** for Neural Turing Machines, invented for its differentiability. In retrospect, it is also a very efficient implementation of associative memory. If we want to improve the Transformer, we should first understand it as an associative memory.

From a **functorial** point of view (eg.[**Crescenzi2024**] [**Abbott2024**] [**Khatri2024**]), one can find a functor that transforms a category $\mathcal{C}$ of KR structure and rewrite morphisms into another category $\mathcal{D}$ with different KR structure and rewrite morphisms. It might just happen that one type of rewrite morphisms are computationally less costly than the other type, and so we have discovered a better, more efficient AGI system. But this maneuver seems not so useful in light of the fact that Transformer / Self Attention is a distributive associative memory that may not care too much about its input representation.

3 Additional Features and Enhancements

If the reader is familiar with classical logic-based AI (or the "neo-classical" OpenCog or OpenNARS), and if you understand our main innovation, the Logic Transformer, as a differentiable "rules-base," then you would have no problem seeing many natural developments that follow from it. If we were to explain them in detail, this paper would blow up to book-length. Instead we just list some new features briefly:

Vector quantization (VQ) of propositions	Seems to be a nice trick, introduced by Copilot without the author's permission. It is a well-known problem in RL that the action space is often too large to be computationally tractable; in the AGI case that action space is the space of all possible / imaginable propositions. Copilot claims that they can be compressed into 8K propositions using a VQ code book. When asked, it explains that it is not 8K distinct propositions, but propositional patterns (see doc #61). Examples like this make us suspect that Copilot is already capable of developing AGI with just a modicum of human guidance.
Hybrid architecture with symbolic logic engine	As our differentiable logic rules become cleanly separable entities, the neural network can easily co-operate with a traditional symbolic inference engine. With a layer of adaptation, it can work with OpenCog/NARS. What advantages will it bring? One example is the ability to quickly incorporate new knowledge into the thinking process. For example, when told that for an Abelian group, $a \cdot b = b \cdot a$, an LLM first places this fact into Working Memory (ie. the prompt), and this may cause the algebraic rule to be applied to new inputs, but this happens through an opaque process, known as long-range dependency, in traditional Transformers. With a symbolic logic engine, the fact $a \cdot b = b \cdot a$ can be directly translated into a logic rule and be immediately applicable.
neo-Davidsonian grammar	A logical form in linguistics, based on events. For example loves(John,Mary) would be loves(e) $\wedge$ Agent(e,John) $\wedge$ Patient(e,Mary) where e is an event. This technique was also suggested by Copilot and adopted by the author.
Representation of Working Memory (WM)	One of the key design choices of an AGI is its representation of WM. OpenCog proposes a hypergraph structure. We explored this issue at length with Copilot.
Reflection	
Reification	
HOL	
Horn form	A logic rule of the form $X \wedge Y \wedge W \wedge ... \rightarrow Z$. Sort of a relic from the past, it makes the implementation of classical symbolic engines easier, eg. PROLOG. Some discussions with Copilot suggest that it is no longer needed; a rule can have multiple heads.

4 Conclusion

We proposed a simple AGI architecture that looks promising. If the Transformer cannot be improved much further, we should perhaps accept the current design and proceed to the "engineering" phase of AGI development.